When Rajiv Saxena, a Dubai-based accountant, and corporate lobbyist Deepak Talwar were brought back to India by a team of law enforcement officers in January 2019, the BJP's official handle was quick to compare Modi to the superhero Batman. 'Last time we saw such swift extradition, it was Batman extraditing Lau from Hong Kong and delivering him to Jim Gordon,' the BJP said. Then it quoted Bruce Wayne: '"Everything's impossible until somebody does it." This time it's PM Narendra Modi.' For a party more used to sanskari talk, the pop-culture reference was surprising, but the tweet quickly went viral. As one user responded, 'Wait. Did BJP just make a Batman reference?' Another one said, 'Did you actually tweet this Batman analogy? You just earned a few more votes for this?'[47]

It is an example that Amit Malviya relates proudly when you ask him about the BJP's communication strategy. In this view, for the party, social media is an alternative, direct outreach platform to the narratives of the mainstream media. 'When I came in here, one of the things that I decided to do was to focus on content. Media has its own priorities. It wants to report on things that it thinks people are interested in, not necessarily what people are wanting to read. It has a certain bent, it has a certain ideological persuasion and their news reportage also reflects that somewhere. There is very little focus on the actual work that happens in the government. So, the thing that we started consciously doing here is to start putting out positive content about what the government is doing. That strategy worked exceedingly well for us because when I took over [in July 2015], our Twitter presence was 17 lakh. By the end of 2019 general election, we have crossed five crore and this was all organic growth. Similarly, on Facebook, we were at about 70 lakh, and by the time of the 2019 election, we had got about four and a half crore followers. Most of it is organic. I realised that a lot of people were coming for content. We used graphics, memes, small videos, snippets. We used more creative content which included different voices of the people, first-party beneficiary account and a lot of youth-centric content. We used a lot of content that people would relate to. We started drawing heavily on movie characters like Batman or Spiderman or those from Bollywood. That worked extremely well for us.'